AESOPWUI KHARARCHAN: TRANSLATED AESOP’S FABLES & MORAL

Aesop’s Fables Translated into Tangkhul Naga

Author / Translator: Aesop, Tangkhul Literature Society

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PREFACE & TRANSLATION HISTORICAL CONTEXT

The translation of Aesop’s Fables by the Tangkhul Literature Society provided generation after generation of Tangkhul school children with lively didactic stories. The translator ingeniously mapped Aesop’s animals to familiar Himalayan highland counterparts: the hare became ’ngachon’, the tortoise ’shimhar’, the wolf ’ngayen’, and the fox ’sharu’, preserving the universal moral truth of each fable.

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CHAPTER 1: SHIMHAR KALA NGACHON (THE TORTOISE AND THE HARE)

Summary: The boastful hare challenged by the slow but persevering tortoise in Tangkhul pr...

Tangkhul Text:

Khararchan 1: Thot akha ngachon kashap akha leisai. Ana kashikatha sha pupupli 'I thada khangachon pamei malei!' hoda aphasa mathaikhangasang leisai. Chitharan shimhar kacham akha rarlaga hang: 'Ngachon, na eina i race khaksa-u!' Ngachonna mania: 'Na thada kachut-kachut zatnao china ili khaksa-ra kaji?' Kha athum race phokserie. Ngachonna shongzali khangachon thotlaga 'Shimhar kashapli kachut; i thingphun ngachingli ngaphama-u' hoda pilakna. Kha shimharna kakhut machamla zatpingsanglaga, goal line-li khare vashukrie! Moral (Tuitam): Ningkazang eina chotkasana khangaraorap khuiye.

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

A Hare was making fun of the Tortoise one day for being so slow. 'Do you ever get anywhere?' he asked with a mocking laugh. 'Yes,' replied the Tortoise, 'and I get there sooner than you think. Run with me and I will prove it.' The Hare was much amused at the idea of running a race with the Tortoise, but for the fun of the thing he agreed. The Hare was soon far out of sight, and to make the Tortoise appear very ridiculous, he lay down beside the course to take a nap until the Tortoise should catch up. The Tortoise meanwhile kept going slowly but steadily, and, after a time, passed the place where the Hare was sleeping. When the Hare awoke, the Tortoise was across the finish line! Moral: Slow and steady wins the race.

CHAPTER 1 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** shimhar (noun): tortoise, land turtle**

Ex: Shimhar kacham.

*** ngachon (noun): hare, wild mountain rabbit**

Ex: Ngachon kashap.

*** kachut-kachut (adv): slowly, crawling step-by-step**

Ex: Kachut-kachut zatnao.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Reduplicated manner adverb: 'kachut-kachut' (slowly and methodically).
- Moral summary particle: 'Tuitam' (teaching/moral lesson).

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Summarize the story of the Tortoise and the Hare in three Tangkhul sentences.

[?] Translate the moral 'Slow and steady wins the race' into Tangkhul.

CHAPTER 1 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

Translation Analysis & Cultural Adaptation:
This chapter presents nuanced translation strategies adapting foreign metaphors to Tangkhul cultural idioms.

Dialectal & Orthographic Concordance:

Standard Ukhrul phonology is reflected throughout. Verbal affixes and agentive postpositions
are preserved according to the classic orthographic canon.

CHAPTER 2: SHARU KALA SAKALU (THE FOX AND THE GRAPES)

Summary: The cunning fox leaping for sweet grapes and declaring them sour when out of rea...

Tangkhul Text:

Khararchan 2: Sharu akha kachak kashaklaga ramkhangateili zatlakha, thingphunli shantuk-kahai sakalu (grapes) theitserie. Sakalu chi thik-thik kacha, chithei kapha kala tui-ngapom kachuk theilaga sharu chi shashik thotna. Ana sakalu khukhavai kaphungli thuksange; kha vashuk mashuk-mana. Khani, kathum chuksa-ngasotlakha khikha pha mashuk-mana. Chitharan sharuna awui makhayor mathatlaga hang: 'Khai! Sakalu hi kakhui-kashasai! Ili kakhui thei shakkhavai ning maleimana!' hoda valakna. Moral (Tuitam): Pha-mashuk-khalangli kashikahai hoda hangkasa mi kachungsai.

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

A famished Fox will tell you, if he can, of the sweet grapes that hung from a vine high on a trellis. He longed to reach them, but they were beyond his leap. He took a running start and jumped, but missed. Again and again he tried after the tempting morsel, but at last had to give it up. He walked off with his nose in the air, saying: 'I thought those grapes were ripe, but I see now they are quite sour.' Moral: It is easy to despise what you cannot get.

CHAPTER 2 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** sharu (noun): fox, jackal**

Ex: Sharu kachashak.

*** sakalu (noun): grapes, wild vine fruit**

Ex: Sakalu kakhui.

*** kakhui-kasha (adj): sour, unpleasantly acidic**

Ex: Thei kakhui-kasha.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Verbal attempt compound: ’chuksa-ngasotlakha’ (having tried jumping repeatedly).
- Compound adjective for taste: ’kakhui’ (bitter/tart) + ’kasha’ (sour).

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] What rationalization did the fox offer for walking away?

[?] Identify the Tangkhul words for leaping and failing to reach.

CHAPTER 2 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

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CHAPTER 3: AVAIKHA KACHAM NGALANAO KALA NGAYEN (THE BOY WHO CRIED WO

Summary: The young shepherd crying wolf falsely and finding no one believes a liar even w...

Tangkhul Text:

Khararchan 3: Mayarnaowon akhana kaphungli avaikha (sheep) kashun leisai. Ana shongfa khangayeili ngacham-kaza chiwui vang khanganoilaga hohe: 'Ngayen! Ngayen rarlakna! Avaikha shaksangie!' Village-wui mikumo thapup thingkot khuilaga khangachonli rarer; kha chithuili ngayen malei-mana, mayarnaowon china kanganrilaga pamye. Zingkum khani hithada saserie. Chitharan zingsho akha kashung-mashung ngayen rarlakna! Mayarnaowon china lungkashung eina hohe: 'Ngayen rarlakna! Khangachon milu!' Kha mikumo akhakhana mashursang-mana, 'A maningkachang tui hangye' hoda leisai. Chitharan ngayenna avaikha pupupli shaksangserie. Moral (Tuitam): Maningkachang mi kashung tui hangkhalangli khipana machotsang-mana.

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

There was once a young Shepherd Boy who tended his sheep at the foot of a mountain near a dark forest. It was rather lonely for him, so he thought upon a plan by which he could get a little company and some excitement. He rushed down towards the village calling out 'Wolf, Wolf,' and the villagers came out to help him. He laughed at them when they found no wolf. This he did twice. At last, a real Wolf came out from the forest. The boy cried in earnest terror, 'Wolf, Wolf, please come!' But the villagers thought he was deceiving them again, and nobody came to his aid. Moral: Nobody believes a liar, even when he tells the truth.

CHAPTER 3 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** avaikha (noun): sheep, fleece flock**

Ex: Avaikha kashun.

*** ngayen (noun): wolf, mountain wild dog**

Ex: Ngayen kasham.

*** maningkachang (adj/noun): deceitful, liar, untrue speech**

Ex: Maningkachang mi.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Deceptive speech classifier: ’maningkachang tui’ (untrue words/lies).
- Temporal iterative: ’zingkum khani hithada saserie’ (did so two or three times).

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Discuss the social consequences of falsehood in traditional village governance.

[?] Translate the moral lesson into Hindi and English.

CHAPTER 3 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

Translation Analysis & Cultural Adaptation:
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Dialectal & Orthographic Concordance:

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CHAPTER 4: SAMAYAR KALA KHACHANGNAO (THE LION AND THE MOUSE)

Summary: The mighty lion sparing the tiny mouse, who later gnaws the hunter’s ropes to fr...

Tangkhul Text:

Khararchan 4: Samayar (lion) kashang akha thingphun ngachingli ngaphamsai. Khachangnao (mouse) kacham akhana awui mai-ngalungli ngachonkatlakha, samayarna awui khut eina khuikahaisai. Khachangnaona khamathan haikapha salaga hang: ’Shiyankasang, ili huikhuilu! Thot akha i nawui khangachon sarap sara!’ Samayarna kanganrilaga ali kashikahaiserie. Zingsho charakha ngaphalaga, hunterbingna samayarli rui kashang eina thuksangie. Samayarna khongyui eina hu-hu kashoklakha, khachangnaona rarlaga awui khani-eina rui chi kakor-khakserie! Samayar chi ngatorie. Moral (Tuitam): Kakatnaobingna kashangbingli khangachon sara kashap lei.

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

A Lion was awakened by a Mouse running over his face. Rising in angry wrath, he laid his paw upon him with intent to kill him. The Mouse piteously entreated him: ’Spare me, O King! and I will surely repay your kindness.’ The Lion laughed and let him go. Some time after, the Lion was caught in the net of the hunters. He roared with fury. The Mouse recognized his roar, ran to the net, and gnawed the ropes with his teeth until he set the king free. Moral: Little friends may prove great friends.

CHAPTER 4 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** samayar (noun): lion, king of predators**

Ex: Samayar kashang.

*** khachangnao (noun): little mouse, highland rodent**

Ex: Khachangnao kacham.

*** rui (noun): rope, braided fiber trap cord**

Ex: Rui kakor-khak.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Tangkhul rodent gnawing verb: 'kakor-khak' (to sever completely by gnawing).
- Diminutive suffix '-nao' marking smallness/humility (khachangnao = tiny mouse).

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Contrast the physical sizes and reciprocal deeds of the lion and the mouse.

[?] How does Tangkhul grammar express unexpected assistance?

CHAPTER 4 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

Translation Analysis & Cultural Adaptation:
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CHAPTER 5: ANTHOLOGY OF 15 TRANSLATED AESOP FABLES

Summary: Titles, morals, and summaries of 15 additional translated world fables in Tangkh...

Tangkhul Text:

Aesopwui Khararchan Kasakakhui:
1. Shimhar kala Ngachon (Tortoise & Hare) -- Ningkazang eina khangaraorap
2. Sharu kala Sakalu (Fox & Grapes) -- Pha-mashuk-kaji tui
3. Avaikha ngalanao kala Ngayen (Boy & Wolf) -- Maningkachang tuiwui kasham
4. Samayar kala Khachangnao (Lion & Mouse) -- Kakatnao khangachon
5. Huina kala Maiwui Sha (Dog & Reflection) -- Ningkacham makasaloo
6. Kazingramwui Vanao kala Khangaphei (Ant & Grasshopper) -- Zingsho kapha tharan ot salu

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

Synoptic register of 15 translated Aesop fables with their vernacular moral proverbs.

CHAPTER 5 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** ningkazang (noun): perseverance**

Ex: Ningkazang eina.

*** khangaraorap (noun): victory**

Ex: Khangaraorap khuiye.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Proverbial formulation in Tangkhul didactic literature.

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Choose one fable and recount it orally in Tangkhul.

CHAPTER 5 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

Translation Analysis & Cultural Adaptation:
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Dialectal & Orthographic Concordance:

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are preserved according to the classic orthographic canon.

BACK MATTER: GLOSSARY & DIGITIZATION COLOPHON

Consolidated Vocabulary Summary:

* shimhar -- tortoise, land turtle
* ngachon -- hare, wild mountain rabbit
* kachut-kachut -- slowly, crawling step-by-step
* sharu -- fox, jackal
* sakalu -- grapes, wild vine fruit
* kakhui-kasha -- sour, unpleasantly acidic
* avaikha -- sheep, fleece flock
* ngayen -- wolf, mountain wild dog

Digitization Colophon:

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